

Şafak Sönmez

Senior Backend Engineer / Technical Lead

Fintech, high-throughput systems, distributed architecture, and real-time platforms.

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PROFILE

Hands-on backend engineer and technical lead with 7+ years across fintech, trading, IoT, and real-time systems. I own backend systems end-to-end from architecture and API/data design through integrations, production deployment, and Kubernetes operations. Track record includes a 10x telemetry-processing throughput improvement and greenfield systems delivered to production.

CORE STRENGTHS

- Technical ownership: architecture decisions, integration design, production delivery, and reliability for integration-heavy backend systems.
- Performance & scale: improved RouteControl telemetry processing from ~80 to ~800 records/sec (10x) through a Node.js-to-Go migration.
- Fintech & real-time systems: trading, exchange/custody, KYC, payments, MT5 workflows, telemetry, and event-driven integrations.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Developer / Technical Lead — Incodi Software Development

Nov 2024 – Present

- Serve as the primary backend technical owner across fintech systems, making architecture and integration decisions and owning production delivery, reliability, and incident troubleshooting.
- Bitexen Exchange / Custody: build multi-tenant Django workflows for KYC lifecycle sync, customer/account provisioning, deposit addresses, withdrawals, balances, statements, and B2B integrations.
- Bitexen Derivatives: worked on a Rust streaming engine with a design target of up to 10,000 trades/sec and MT5 gateway/backend workflows covering account state, history, liquidation flows, and integrations.

Backend Developer / Technical Lead — Yukatech AS

Jan 2022 – Oct 2024

- Promoted to Backend Lead in the second year; led backend architecture and delivery for RouteControl and YukaTrack.
- Migrated RouteControl processing from Node.js to Go, increasing throughput from ~80 to ~800 telemetry records/sec (10x) using goroutines and concurrency-safe synchronization patterns.
- Built Teltonika binary telemetry, Go/gRPC, MongoDB/Redis/RabbitMQ services, and operated a custom Nominatim geolocation stack.

Backend Developer (Part-Time) — GoAction

May 2022 – Feb 2023

- Built event-driven Node.js services using AWS Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, and AWS SDK.

Freelance Full Stack / Backend Developer — Independent

Sep 2019 – Dec 2021

- Delivered commercial .NET, Node.js, Python, Laravel, and React applications, including crypto-exchange/arbitrage tooling and real-time integrations.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- RideOn / DriveOn: built with an independent 3-person team from greenfield to production, covering MQTT/live telemetry backends, real-time client flows, React Native delivery, and Docker/Kubernetes deployment.
- Additional architecture work: production experience with GraphQL, CQRS, and Event Sourcing; used Kafka in side projects for event-driven messaging experiments.

TECHNOLOGIES

Languages & Frameworks: C#/.NET, Go, Node.js/TypeScript, Python/Django, Rust, Laravel, React/React Native, GraphQL

Architecture & Messaging: Distributed/Event-Driven Systems, CQRS, Event Sourcing, RabbitMQ, MQTT, gRPC, WebSockets/Socket.IO; Kafka (side projects)

Data: PostgreSQL, MSSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, AWS Lambda/API Gateway, CI/CD, Nginx, Traefik

Domain: Fintech, trading, exchange/custody, payments, KYC, MT5, market data, telemetry

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Çanakkale Onsekiz Mart University — Computer Programming, Associate Degree (2017–2019) • Turkish: Native • English: Professional working proficiency